



European influences

During the 16th century, the human landscape of South America changed dramatically with the arrival of colonists from southern Europe. Their influence spread quickly and completely, and today many aspects of culture in South America are still dominated by ideas and traditions that originated in Spain and Portugal.



LIQUID HISTORY

Early Europeans who settled in South America brought with them wine making skills from Spain and Portugal. The vines they planted are now the basis of flourishing wine industries in countries like Chile and Argentina.

A MATTER OF FAITH

Roman Catholicism replaced the original belief systems of nearly all the indigenous peoples in South America. This dominance is reflected in the elaborate church architecture that is a feature of virtually every town and city on the continent. Built on the site of an old Inca temple, for example, this cathedral in Cuzco, Peru, clearly reflects Spanish influences.



RELIGIOUS FESTIVAL

Like most indigenous peoples, the Otavalens of Ecuador are largely Catholic. Here, the devout gather for worship on Palm Sunday, their bright costumes contrasting dramatically with the jungle of pale green leaves they have brought to church to mark this special day.



MUSIC

Now an important part of South American music, the guitar was brought over by early Spanish explorers. Their instruments helped them to pass the time on long voyages.



LACES AND NETS

The skill of lace making arrived in Brazil with the wives of Portuguese fishermen who settled there. The Portuguese word for lace makers is *rendeiras*.



OLD-WORLD DRESS

The traditional clothing worn by Taquile islanders in Lake Titicaca developed from the garments worn by Spanish settlers when they first arrived in Peru.

